



RSPB reclaims crown



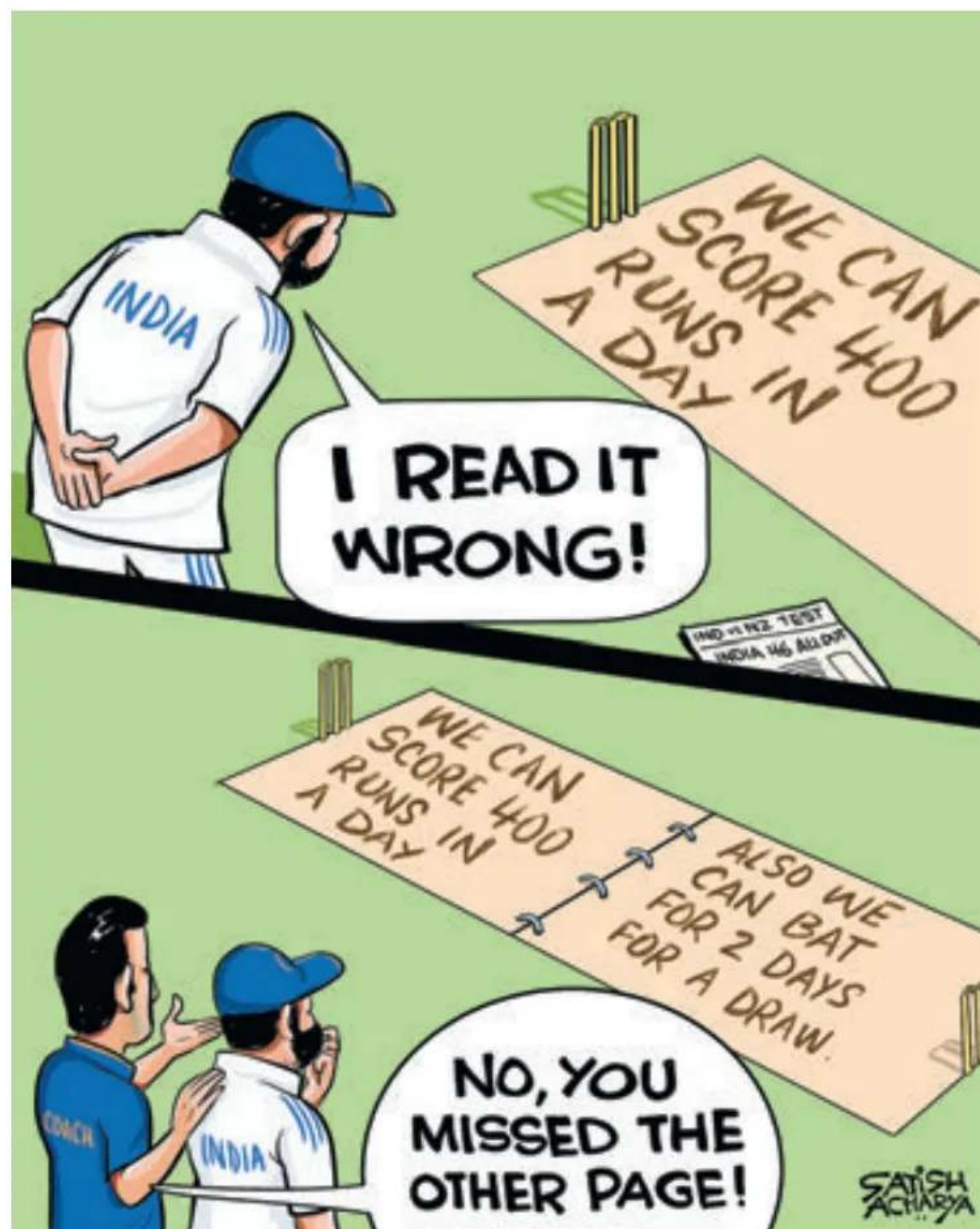
Railway Sports Promotion Board (RSPB) reclaimed the crown with a 3-1 win against Indian Oil Corporation Limited at the fourth Hockey India Women's Inter-Departmental National Championships, avenging its defeat last year.

With the cream of Indian women's hockey in action and Railways desperate to prove its dominance in a grudge match, the final was expected to be an exciting affair, and the two teams did not disappoint. Defending champion IOCL, after a first quarter of tentativeness, took the lead through Deepika but could sustain the lead for less than a minute, Vandana Katariya bringing all her 300-plus international match experience to level scores immediately. Just when it looked like the game would go into a shootout, like last year, Navneet Kaur put Railways ahead with a powerful shot in the 43rd minute, and Salima Tete (**pic, above**) doubled the lead six minutes later. Despite its control in the game, however, Railways did not push further, wiser after the 2023 final when, leading by a similar margin, it ended up conceding twice in the final minutes. This time, however, there was no mistake. Salima was adjudged the Player of the Match.

UTHRA GANESAN

» INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



1 India will host the Asian Women's Handball Championship for the first time in New Delhi from December 1 to 10, 2024. The 20th edition of the tournament was originally set to take place in Almaty, Kazakhstan, but unforeseen circumstances led to its relocation — presenting India with a golden opportunity. Alongside India, the competition will witness continental heavyweights, Iran, South Korea, China, Japan, Kazakhstan, Hong Kong, and Singapore in action. The championship is scheduled to take place at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium.

TEAM SPORTSTAR

2 The second edition of the Chennai Grand Masters chess tournament will take place in the city from November 5 to November 11. With an official average rating of 2711 Elo, last year's inaugural edition was the strongest classical chess tournament ever held in India. In the previous tournament, D. Gukesh and Arjun Erigaisi finished tied for first place, but Gukesh emerged victorious based on his superior tiebreaks. This victory was pivotal for Gukesh, as it earned him important FIDE circuit points and secured his entry into the FIDE Candidates tournament, where he ultimately became the champion.

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